

IT-SIMPLERA INSTITUTE



Cyber Security Analyst Internship Program

WEEK 01 TASK

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July 2026

Introduction

As part of Week 01 of the Cyber Security Analyst Internship Program at IT-SIMPLERA Institute, this report covers the fundamental concepts of cybersecurity that every analyst should understand before progressing to more advanced topics. Since my internship domain is Red Team and Offensive Security, I have related each task to the mindset and responsibilities of an offensive security professional.

This report examines five real-world cyberattacks and analyses their impact using the CIA Triad. It also reviews three cybersecurity tools commonly used in security assessments, presents a secure home network design based on cybersecurity best practices, and explains the daily responsibilities of a cybersecurity analyst. Completing this assignment has strengthened my understanding of core cybersecurity principles and helped me connect theoretical knowledge with practical, real-world applications.

TASK 1: FIVE REAL-WORLD CYBERATTACKS

The CIA Triad, consisting of Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability, is a fundamental framework in information security used to assess how cyberattacks affect information systems. Confidentiality ensures that sensitive information is accessible only to authorized individuals. Integrity ensures that data remains accurate, complete, and free from unauthorized modification. Availability ensures that systems, services, and data are accessible to authorized users whenever they are needed.

The following section examines five significant real-world cyberattacks and evaluates each incident based on the component or components of the CIA Triad that were compromised. This analysis demonstrates how different types of cyberattacks impact organizations and highlights the importance of implementing effective security controls to protect information assets.

Summary Table

S/ N	Cyberattack	Year	Attack Type	CIA Triad Affected
1	WannaCry ransomware attack	2017	Ransomware	Confidentiality, Availability
2	Equifax data breach	2017	Data Breach	Confidentiality
3	SolarWinds supply chain attack	2020	Supply Chain Attack	Integrity, Confidentiality

4	Colonial Pipeline ransomware attack	2021	Ransomware	Availability
5	Yahoo data breaches	2013-2014	Data Breach	Confidentiality

1. WannaCry ransomware attack (2017)



Overview

The WannaCry ransomware attack was one of the most destructive cyberattacks in history. It began on 12 May 2017 and spread rapidly across more than 150 countries, infecting over 200,000 computers within a few days. The attackers exploited a vulnerability in Microsoft Windows known as EternalBlue, which targeted the Server Message Block (SMB) protocol. Once a computer was infected, the ransomware encrypted files and demanded payment in Bitcoin to restore access.

How the Attack Happened

The attackers used the EternalBlue exploit, which had been leaked from the United States National Security Agency (NSA). Many organizations had not installed Microsoft's available security update, allowing the malware to spread automatically between vulnerable computers without user interaction.

Impact

- More than 200,000 computers were infected.
- Hospitals under the United Kingdom's National Health Service cancelled appointments and delayed medical procedures.

- Businesses, government agencies, universities, and telecommunications companies experienced operational disruptions.
- Global financial losses were estimated in the billions of dollars.

CIA Triad Affected

Component	Effect
Confidentiality	Attackers gained unauthorized access to vulnerable systems before encrypting files.
Integrity	Files were modified through encryption, making their original contents inaccessible.
Availability	Systems and files became unavailable until they were restored from backups or decrypted.

Lessons Learned

- Apply security patches promptly.
- Maintain regular offline backups.
- Disable unnecessary network services.
- Deploy endpoint protection solutions.
- Train users to recognize cyber threats.

2. Equifax data breach (2017)



Overview

The Equifax data breach is one of the largest and most significant data breaches in history. Between May and July 2017, cybercriminals exploited a vulnerability in the company's online dispute portal, gaining unauthorized access to highly sensitive personal information. The breach affected approximately 147 million individuals, exposing names, Social Security numbers, birth dates, addresses, driver's license numbers, and, in some cases, credit card information.

How the Attack Happened

The attackers exploited an unpatched vulnerability in the Apache Struts web application framework. Although a security patch had been released months earlier, Equifax failed to apply it promptly, allowing attackers to access the company's systems and extract sensitive customer data over several weeks.

Impact

- Personal information of approximately 147 million people was compromised.
- The company suffered significant financial losses through legal settlements and regulatory penalties.
- Customer trust and the company's reputation were severely damaged.
- The incident prompted organizations worldwide to strengthen their vulnerability management practices.

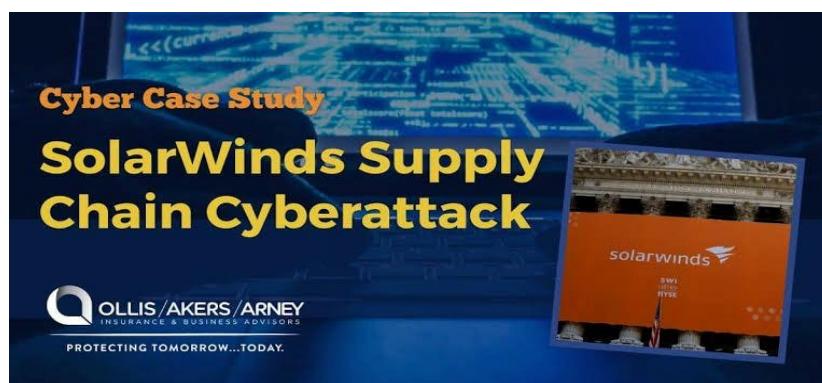
CIA Triad Affected

COMPONENT	EFFECT
Confidentiality	Sensitive personal and financial information was accessed without authorization.
Integrity	No significant evidence indicated that customer data was altered.
Availability	Company services remained largely available throughout the incident.

Lessons Learned

- Apply security patches immediately after release.
- Conduct regular vulnerability assessments.
- Encrypt sensitive customer data.
- Implement continuous security monitoring.
- Establish an effective patch management program.

3. SolarWinds supply chain attack (2020)



Overview

The SolarWinds cyberattack was a sophisticated supply chain attack discovered in December 2020. Attackers compromised SolarWinds’ software development environment and inserted

malicious code into updates for the Orion network management platform. Organizations that installed the compromised updates unknowingly gave attackers access to their internal networks.

How the Attack Happened

The attackers infiltrated SolarWinds' software build process and embedded malicious code into legitimate software updates. Thousands of customers downloaded the infected updates, allowing attackers to establish backdoor access to government agencies and private organizations.

Impact

- Multiple government agencies were compromised.
- Numerous multinational organizations were affected.
- Sensitive government and corporate information was exposed.
- The incident highlighted weaknesses in software supply chain security.

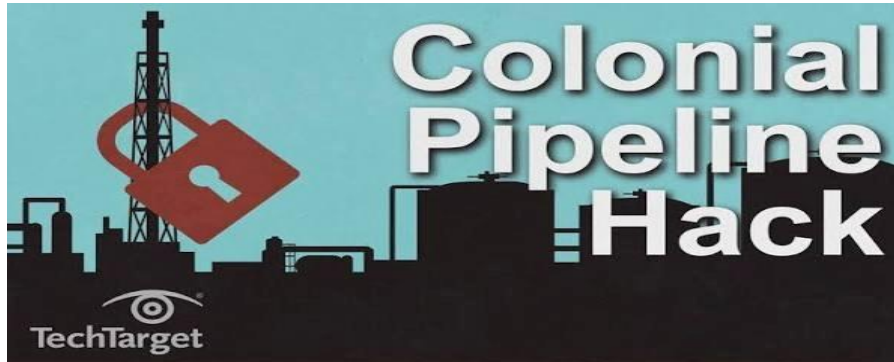
CIA Triad Affected

Component	Effect
Confidentiality	Attackers gained unauthorized access to confidential information.
Integrity	Legitimate software updates were modified with malicious code before
Availability	Most affected systems remained operational during the attack.

Lessons Learned

- Secure software development environments.
- Verify software updates before deployment.
- Monitor networks for unusual activity.
- Adopt a Zero Trust security model.
- Strengthen third-party risk management.

4. Colonial Pipeline ransomware attack (2021)



Overview

In May 2021, Colonial Pipeline, one of the largest fuel pipeline operators in the United States, suffered a ransomware attack carried out by the DarkSide ransomware group. To prevent further damage, the company temporarily shut down pipeline operations, disrupting fuel distribution across several states.

How the Attack Happened

The attackers reportedly gained access using a compromised virtual private network (VPN) account that lacked multi-factor authentication. After accessing the company's systems, they deployed ransomware that encrypted critical business data and demanded payment for its recovery.

Impact

- Fuel shortages occurred across parts of the eastern United States.
- Panic buying caused long queues at petrol stations.
- Pipeline operations were temporarily suspended.
- The company paid millions of dollars in ransom, although part of the payment was later recovered by law enforcement.

CIA Triad Affected

Component	Effect
Confidentiality	Business Information was accessed by attackers
Integrity	Business data was encrypted, preventing normal use
Availability	Pipeline operations and business systems became temporarily unavailable

Lessons Learned

- Enable multi-factor authentication for remote access.
- Monitor privileged accounts continuously.
- Maintain secure offline backups.
- Develop and regularly test incident response plans.
- Segment critical operational networks.

5. Yahoo data breaches (2013–2014)



Overview

The Yahoo data breaches, disclosed in 2016, remain among the largest cybersecurity incidents ever recorded. The attacks, which occurred in 2013 and 2014, compromised all Yahoo user accounts, affecting approximately three billion users. Stolen information included names, email addresses, telephone numbers, dates of birth, hashed passwords, and security questions.

How the Attack Happened

Attackers gained unauthorized access to Yahoo's systems through weaknesses in the company's security infrastructure. They remained undetected for an extended period, allowing them to steal massive amounts of customer information before the breach was discovered and publicly disclosed.

Impact

- Approximately three billion user accounts were compromised.
- Yahoo's reputation suffered significant damage.
- The company's acquisition value decreased during its sale process.

- Millions of users were required to change their passwords and strengthen account security.

CIA Triad Affected

Component	Effect
Confidentiality	Personal user information was stolen by unauthorized individuals
Integrity	There was limited evidence that user records were modified
Availability	Yahoo's services generally remained available throughout the incident

Lessons Learned

- Protect user credentials using strong encryption and hashing algorithms.
- Detect and respond to intrusions promptly.
- Conduct regular security audits and penetration tests.
- Implement continuous monitoring and threat detection.
- Encourage users to enable multi-factor authentication.

TASK 2: THREE CYBERSECURITY TOOLS

Cybersecurity professionals rely on specialized tools to identify vulnerabilities, analyze network traffic, assess system security, and respond to cyber threats. These tools play a vital role in both defensive and offensive security operations by helping security professionals identify weaknesses before attackers can exploit them. As a Red Team and Offensive Security intern, developing practical knowledge of these tools is essential for conducting security assessments and penetration testing.

The following section examines three widely used cybersecurity tools: Wireshark, Nmap, and Burp Suite. Each tool serves a distinct purpose in cybersecurity and is commonly used by security analysts, penetration testers, and ethical hackers.

2.1 Wireshark



Overview

Wireshark is a free and open-source network protocol analyzer used to capture and inspect data packets traveling across a network. It allows cybersecurity professionals to observe network communications in real time, making it one of the most widely used tools for network analysis, troubleshooting, and incident investigation.

Key Features

- Captures live network traffic.
- Supports deep inspection of hundreds of network protocols.
- Filters packets using powerful search expressions.
- Detects suspicious or abnormal network activity.
- Exports captured traffic for further analysis.

Common Use Cases

- Network troubleshooting.
- Malware traffic analysis.
- Incident response investigations.
- Detection of unauthorized network communications.
- Security monitoring and forensic investigations.

Relevance to Red Team / Offensive Security

During penetration testing, Wireshark helps security professionals observe how applications communicate across a network, identify unencrypted traffic, analyze authentication mechanisms, and verify whether sensitive information is transmitted securely.

Advantages

- Free and open source.
- Supports Windows, Linux, and macOS.
- Extensive protocol support.
- Large community and documentation.

Limitations

- Requires networking knowledge to interpret captured traffic.
- Cannot decrypt encrypted traffic without the necessary encryption keys.

2.2 Nmap (Network Mapper)



```
root@kali:~/home/spect# nmap -sV scanme.nmap.org -oX /home/spect/scanResults.xml
Starting Nmap 7.80 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2021-01-18 23:25 +01
Nmap scan report for scanme.nmap.org (45.33.32.156)
Host is up (0.21s latency).
Other addresses for scanme.nmap.org (not scanned): 2600:13c01::f03c:91ff:fe18:bb2f
Not shown: 907 closed ports
PORT      STATE SERVICE
22/tcp    open  ssh
25/tcp    filtered smtp
80/tcp    open  http
135/tcp    filtered msrpc
139/tcp    filtered netbios-ssn
445/tcp    filtered microsoft-ds
593/tcp    filtered http-rpc-epmap
1008/tcp   filtered instl_bootc
4444/tcp   filtered krb524
5800/tcp   filtered vnc-http
5900/tcp   filtered vnc
9929/tcp   open  nping-echo
31337/tcp  open  tcpwrapped
Service Info: OS: Linux; CPE: cpe:/o:ubuntu:ubuntu2.13 (Ubuntu Linux; protocol 2.0)
Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 30.35 seconds
```

Overview

Nmap is a free and open-source network scanning tool used to discover devices connected to a network and identify the services running on those devices. It is one of the most widely used reconnaissance tools in cybersecurity and serves as the foundation for many penetration testing activities.

Key Features

- Host discovery.
- Port scanning.

- Service and version detection.
- Operating system detection.
- Network inventory generation.
- Vulnerability detection through scripting.

Common Use Cases

- Network reconnaissance.
- Identifying open ports.
- Detecting vulnerable services.
- Security auditing.
- Asset discovery.

Relevance to Red Team / Offensive Security

Nmap is often the first tool used during a penetration test. It enables Red Team professionals to identify active hosts, discover exposed services, detect operating systems, and gather information needed to plan security assessments.

Advantages

- Free and open source.
- Fast and accurate scanning.
- Highly customizable.
- Supports automation using the Nmap Scripting Engine (NSE).

Limitations

- Aggressive scans may trigger intrusion detection systems.
- Large network scans can take considerable time.

2.3 Burp Suite

The screenshot displays the Burp Suite interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with tabs: Dashboard, Target, Proxy, Intruder, Repeater, Collaborator, Sequencer, Decoder, Comparer, Logger, Extensions, and Organizer. Below this, the 'HTTP history' tab is active, showing a list of intercepted requests. The table has columns for #, Host, Method, Params, URL, Edited, Status code, Length, MIME type, Extension, and Title. The first few entries are GET requests to https://portswigger.net.

Below the table, the 'Request' and 'Response' sections are visible. The 'Request' section shows the raw HTTP request, including the method (GET), host (portswigger.net), and various cookies and headers. The 'Response' section shows the raw HTTP response, including the status code (200 OK), date (Wed, 03 Jul 2024 08:49:07 GMT), content-type (image/svg+xml), and other headers.

Overview

Burp Suite is a comprehensive web application security testing platform developed by PortSwigger. It enables security professionals to identify vulnerabilities in websites and web applications by intercepting, modifying, and analyzing HTTP and HTTPS traffic between a user's browser and the target application.

Key Features

- Intercepting Proxy.
- Repeater for modifying requests.
- Intruder for automated testing.
- Scanner for vulnerability detection (Professional Edition).
- Decoder and Comparer utilities.
- Session handling and authentication testing.

Common Use Cases

- Web application penetration testing.
- API security testing.
- Authentication testing.
- Session management analysis.
- SQL Injection and Cross-Site Scripting (XSS) testing.

Relevance to Red Team / Offensive Security

Burp Suite is one of the primary tools used by Red Team professionals to identify security weaknesses in web applications. It allows testers to intercept requests, manipulate user input, bypass security controls, and validate vulnerabilities before they can be exploited by malicious attackers.

Advantages

- Industry-standard web security testing platform.
- User-friendly interface.
- Extensive functionality for manual testing.
- Supports extensions through the Bapp Store.

Limitations

- Some advanced features require the Professional Edition.
- Effective use requires a solid understanding of web technologies.

Summary

Wireshark, Nmap, and Burp Suite each perform different but complementary functions within cybersecurity. Wireshark focuses on network traffic analysis, Nmap specializes in network reconnaissance and service discovery, while Burp Suite is designed for web application security testing. Together, these tools provide cybersecurity professionals with the capabilities needed to identify vulnerabilities, assess security controls, and strengthen the overall security posture of an organization.

Feature	Wireshark	Nmap	Burp Suite
Primary Purpose	Analyze and capture network traffic	Discover hosts, ports, and services on a network	Test the security of web applications
Category	Network Protocol Analyzer	Network Scanner	Web Application Security Testing Tool
Primary Users	Network Administrators, SOC Analysts, Incident Responders	Penetration Testers, Network Administrators, Security Analysts	Penetration Testers, Ethical Hackers, Security Consultants
Platform Support	Windows, Linux, macOS	Windows, Linux, macOS	Windows, Linux, macOS
License	Free and Open Source	Free and Open Source	Community Edition (Free) and Professional Edition (Paid)

Main Functions	Packet capture, protocol analysis, network troubleshooting	Host discovery, port scanning, service detection, OS detection	HTTP/HTTPS interception, vulnerability testing, web application assessment
Typical Use Cases	Network monitoring, malware analysis, digital forensics	Network reconnaissance, security auditing, vulnerability discovery	Web penetration testing, API testing, authentication testing
Supports Automation	Limited	Yes, through the Nmap Scripting Engine (NSE)	Yes, through extensions and automation features
Strengths	Detailed packet inspection and protocol analysis	Fast, accurate, and flexible network scanning	Comprehensive web application security testing
Limitations	Requires networking knowledge and cannot decrypt encrypted traffic without keys	Large scans may take time and generate security alerts	Advanced scanning features are available only in the Professional Edition

Each of these tools serves a different purpose within the cybersecurity lifecycle. Wireshark specializes in capturing and analyzing network traffic, making it valuable for troubleshooting, monitoring, and forensic investigations. Nmap focuses on network reconnaissance by identifying active hosts, open ports, running services, and operating systems, which makes it an essential tool during the information-gathering phase of penetration testing. Burp Suite is designed specifically for web application security testing, allowing security professionals to identify and validate vulnerabilities such as SQL injection, Cross-Site Scripting (XSS), and authentication weaknesses. Together, these tools provide complementary capabilities that support both defensive security operations and offensive security assessments.

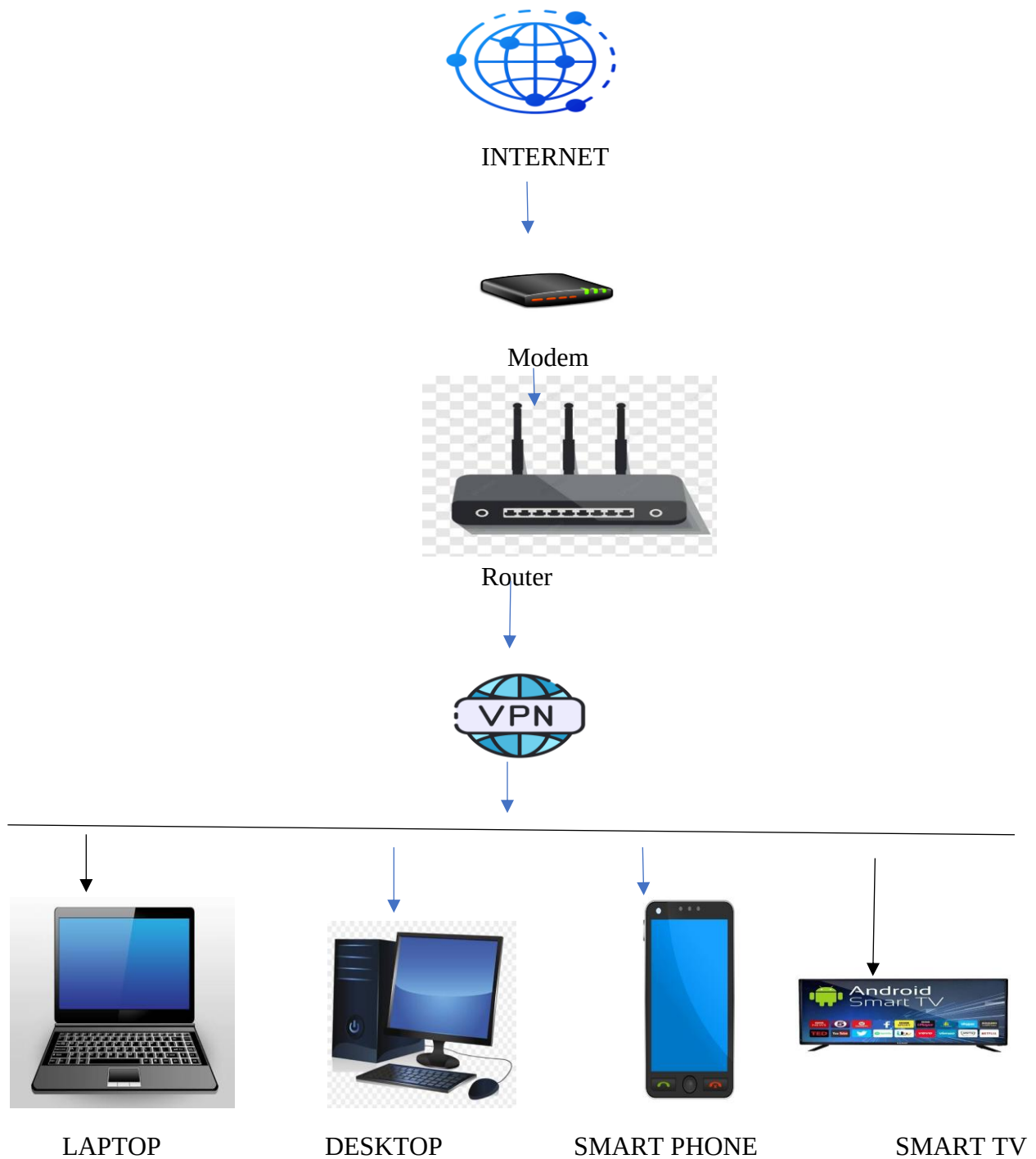
TASK 3: DESIGN OF A SECURE HOME NETWORK

Introduction

A secure home network is the first line of defense against cyber threats targeting personal devices and sensitive information. As more activities such as online banking, remote work, e-learning, and cloud storage rely on internet connectivity, securing a home network has become increasingly important. A well-designed home network protects users from unauthorized access, malware, phishing attacks, and data theft by implementing appropriate security controls and best practices.

The diagram below illustrates a secure home network configuration suitable for a typical household. It demonstrates how network devices are connected and identifies the security mechanisms used to protect communication between connected devices and the internet.

Secure Home Network Diagram



Components of the Network

Internet

The internet provides external connectivity, allowing users to access websites, cloud services, email, and other online resources.

ISP Modem

The modem connects the home network to the Internet Service Provider (ISP) and converts internet signals into a format that can be used by local devices.

Router with Firewall

The router distributes internet connectivity to all devices within the home. Its built-in firewall filters incoming and outgoing network traffic, blocking unauthorized access while allowing legitimate communications.

Laptop and Desktop Computer

These devices are used for work, education, and personal activities. They should be protected with antivirus software, strong passwords, and regular operating system updates.

Smartphone

Mobile devices should connect only through the secured wireless network and should use device encryption, screen locks, and updated operating systems.

Smart TV

Although primarily used for entertainment, smart TVs are internet-connected devices that should receive firmware updates to address security vulnerabilities.

Security Measures Implemented

The following security controls strengthen the security of the home network:

- WPA3 encryption secures wireless communication against unauthorized access.
- A strong Wi-Fi password reduces the risk of brute-force attacks.
- The router's firewall filters malicious traffic entering or leaving the network.
- Antivirus software protects devices from malware and ransomware.
- Automatic software updates ensure known vulnerabilities are patched promptly.
- A Virtual Private Network (VPN) encrypts internet traffic when accessing public networks.
- Strong, unique passwords are used for all connected devices and online accounts.

- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) is enabled wherever possible to provide an additional layer of security.
- Regular backups ensure important files can be restored after hardware failure or cyber incidents.

Conclusion

A secure home network combines appropriate hardware, secure configurations, and good cybersecurity practices to protect connected devices and sensitive information. Implementing measures such as firewalls, WPA3 encryption, software updates, antivirus protection, and strong authentication significantly reduces the risk of cyberattacks and helps maintain the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information within the home environment.

TASK 4: WHAT DOES A CYBERSECURITY ANALYST DO EVERY DAY?

Introduction

A Cybersecurity Analyst is responsible for protecting an organization's information systems, networks, applications, and digital assets from cyber threats. The role combines technical expertise, analytical thinking, and continuous monitoring to identify vulnerabilities, detect malicious activities, and respond to security incidents. Cybersecurity analysts work proactively to reduce security risks and ensure the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of organizational data.

Daily Responsibilities of a Cybersecurity Analyst

1. Monitoring Security Alerts

Cybersecurity analysts continuously monitor alerts generated by security tools such as Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, firewalls, endpoint detection and response (EDR) solutions, and antivirus software. Their objective is to identify suspicious activities before they develop into security incidents.

2. Investigating Security Incidents

When suspicious activity is detected, analysts investigate the event to determine whether it represents a genuine cyberattack or a false positive. This process involves collecting evidence, reviewing logs, analyzing network traffic, and identifying the source and impact of the incident.

3. Performing Vulnerability Assessments

Cybersecurity analysts regularly scan systems, networks, and applications to identify security weaknesses. After identifying vulnerabilities, they recommend corrective actions such as applying software patches, strengthening configurations, or implementing additional security controls to reduce organizational risk.

4. Reviewing System and Network Logs

Log analysis is an essential daily activity. Analysts examine operating system logs, firewall logs, authentication records, and application logs to detect unusual behavior, unauthorized access attempts, and indicators of compromise that might otherwise go unnoticed.

5. Monitoring Threat Intelligence

Cyber threats evolve rapidly. Analysts review threat intelligence reports, security advisories, and vulnerability disclosures to remain informed about newly discovered malware, ransomware campaigns, software vulnerabilities, and attacker techniques. This knowledge enables organizations to strengthen their defenses before attacks occur.

6. Responding to Cybersecurity Incidents

When a cyberattack occurs, cybersecurity analysts assist in containing the threat, removing malicious software, restoring affected systems, and minimizing operational disruption. They work closely with incident response teams to recover systems while preserving evidence for investigation.

7. Conducting Security Awareness Activities

Human error remains one of the leading causes of cybersecurity incidents. Analysts help educate employees on cybersecurity best practices, including recognizing phishing emails, creating strong passwords, enabling Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and handling sensitive information securely.

8. Preparing Reports and Documentation

Cybersecurity analysts document security incidents, investigation findings, vulnerabilities, and recommendations. These reports help management understand organizational risks and support future security improvements, compliance requirements, and audit activities.

Skills Required

To perform these responsibilities effectively, cybersecurity analysts require both technical and professional skills, including:

- Networking fundamentals
- Operating system administration (Windows and Linux)
- Web application security
- Vulnerability assessment
- Basic scripting or programming
- Critical thinking
- Problem-solving
- Communication skills
- Attention to detail
- Teamwork

Importance of the Role

Cybersecurity analysts play a critical role in protecting organizations against cyber threats. Their work helps prevent data breaches, minimize financial losses, maintain customer trust, ensure regulatory compliance, and support business continuity. By continuously monitoring systems and responding to threats, they contribute significantly to maintaining a secure digital environment.

Conclusion

The responsibilities of a cybersecurity analyst extend beyond responding to attacks. They proactively identify vulnerabilities, monitor security events, investigate suspicious activities, educate users, and strengthen organizational defenses against evolving cyber threats. As technology continues to advance and cyberattacks become more sophisticated, the role of the cybersecurity analyst remains essential in safeguarding information systems and ensuring the resilience of modern organizations.

CONCLUSION

This report provided an overview of the fundamental concepts covered during Week 1 of the Cyber Security Analyst Internship Program at IT-SIMPLERA Institute. Through the analysis of five real-world cyberattacks, the application of the CIA Triad was demonstrated, showing how cyber incidents affect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information systems. Understanding these attacks provides valuable insight into the methods used by threat actors and the importance of implementing effective security controls.

The report also examined three widely used cybersecurity tools, namely Wireshark, Nmap, and Burp Suite, highlighting their features, practical applications, and relevance to Red Team and Offensive Security activities. In addition, a secure home network design was presented to illustrate how appropriate network architecture and security measures can protect connected devices against common cyber threats.

Finally, the report discussed the daily responsibilities of a cybersecurity analyst, emphasizing the importance of continuous monitoring, vulnerability assessment, incident response, security awareness, and effective documentation. These responsibilities are essential for maintaining a strong security posture within modern organizations.

Completing this assignment has strengthened my understanding of core cybersecurity concepts and provided practical knowledge that will support my development throughout the internship. It has also reinforced the importance of continuous learning, hands-on practice, and adherence to cybersecurity best practices in addressing today's evolving threat landscape.

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